LAUNCHPAD PREP GUIDE

Interview preparation tips

Common interview questions, and how to give clear, strong answers.

Why preparation matters

An interview is a conversation where an employer finds out whether you suit the role. For an apprenticeship, they do not expect you to have done the job before. They want to see your strengths, your interest in the role and your willingness to learn. Preparing helps you feel calm and give clear answers.

At Amazon you may have a recorded video interview and live interviews at the assessment centre. You may have one interview or several. They can be in person, on the phone or on a video call.

How to prepare

1. Read the programme description and list the skills it asks for.
2. Research Amazon and the programme. Know what the team does and why you want to join it.
3. Read Amazon's 16 Leadership Principles. Amazon says its interviews focus heavily on them.
4. Look over your CV and application, and think about what they might ask you.
5. Prepare 4 to 6 real examples from your life that show different skills.
6. Practise saying your answers out loud with someone you trust.
7. Write down 2 or 3 questions to ask at the end.

How to answer: the STAR method

Many questions start with "Tell me about a time when..." The STAR method is a simple way to answer them in four parts:

Part	What to say
Situation	Set the scene in one or two sentences. Where were you and what was going on?
Task	What did you need to do? What was your part?
Action	What did you do, step by step? Say "I", not "we", so they know what you did.
Result	What happened in the end, and what did you learn?

Spend most of your answer on the Action. Keep each answer short, about one to two minutes. Your examples can come from school, college, part-time work, sport, clubs, volunteering or home.

Example: "Tell me about a time you worked in a team."

Situation: Our school football team needed new kit but had no money for it.

Task: I offered to help organise a bake sale to raise the money.

Action: I asked who wanted to help, held a short meeting to agree a date, and gave everyone a clear job, such as baking, making posters or running the stall.

Result: We raised £200 and bought the new kit. I learned that giving people clear jobs makes a group work better.

Common questions and what they want to know

Question	What a good answer shows
Tell me about yourself.	A short summary: what you are studying, what you enjoy and why this programme interests you. Keep it to about one minute.
Why do you want this apprenticeship?	That you have researched the programme, and how it links to what you want to do.
Why Amazon?	Something real you know about Amazon, such as its work in your area of interest or one of its Leadership Principles that matches how you work.
Tell me about a time you solved a problem.	How you think: what the problem was, the steps you took and what happened.
Tell me about a time something went wrong.	That you take responsibility, learn from mistakes and try again. Be honest.
Tell me about a time you learned something new.	That you are curious and willing to learn, which links to Learn and Be Curious.
What are your strengths?	Two or three strengths, each backed up by a short example.
Do you have any questions for us?	That you are interested. Always ask at least one.

Good questions to ask at the end

- What does a normal week look like for an apprentice in this team?
- How will my learning be split between work and study?
- What do your most successful apprentices have in common?
- What are the next steps, and when should I expect to hear back?

Tips for the recorded video interview

- Sit somewhere quiet with light in front of you, not behind you.
- Place your camera at eye level and look into the camera, not at the screen.

- Do a practice recording first to check your sound and picture.
- Use any thinking time to note the S, T, A and R of your answer before you start.

During the interview

- Be ready 5 to 10 minutes early. For online interviews, check your equipment first.
- If you do not understand a question, ask them to repeat or explain it.
- It is fine to pause and think before you answer.
- Answer honestly. If you have not done something, say so, then explain how you would approach it.
- Be ready for follow-up questions about your examples, so only use examples you know well.
- Speak naturally. You want to sound prepared, not like you are reading a script.

After the interview

Write down the questions you were asked while you still remember them. If you do not get the role, ask for feedback. It is normal to have several interviews before getting an offer.

Where this advice comes from

This guide was written from these sources, checked in October 2026. Amazon can change its process, so always read the instructions it sends you.

- Amazon Apprenticeships - Application Support
- Amazon Leadership Principles
- 5 things you need to know when applying for an Amazon apprenticeship
- National Careers Service - Interview tips
- National Careers Service - The STAR method
- GOV.UK - Getting an apprenticeship